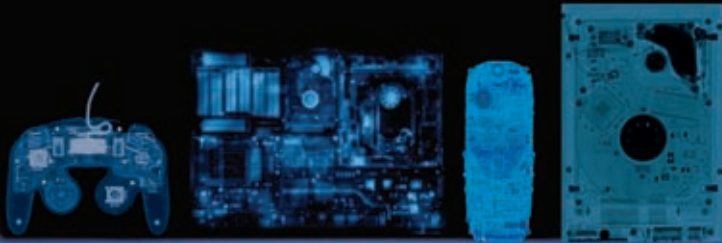


Smugglegally



Frustrated because you don't have access to the latest gadgets? It's time you discovered the world of global online shopping. Here's our guide to smarter online shopping from international e-stores...

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With the opening of markets and relaxation of the duty structure, the novelty of getting gadgets from abroad for cheap has seen some decline, but there's still the temptation to get hold of the latest tech before its official launch in India. Fortunately, you no longer need to depend on the grey market to be a proud owner of the latest gizmos!

International shopping is now at your fingertips. It can be quite effective and even economical if done correctly. So let us look at how online shopping has enabled placement of international orders for cool gadgets right from the comfort of your homes sans the headache of figuring out the custom duties and hassles of managing the shipment.

A quick reality check

Firstly, any international transaction requires a credit card. Before you start planning your purchase, ensure you have a valid international credit card (preferably a VISA card) with enough credit limit. Secondly, all that comfort of getting products delivered to your doorstep does come at a cost. You'll pay for the custom duties on the products, the taxes applicable in the country that the purchase is made from, plus the shipping charges and a slight overhead for the conven-

ience. Therefore, it's not as simple as converting the international pricing into Indian rupees. The overhead cost above the international pricing ranges roughly between 25-35 per cent of the quoted price of the product on the web site. Another thing is the delivery time, which can take anywhere between 7 to 15 days.

Ready to shop?

Let us look at the options...

eBay Global Easy Buy

eBay Global Easy Buy is our favourite of the lot, and is strongly recommended for anyone venturing into online international shopping. Global Easy Buy gives you the final prices in Indian rupees that include all costs such as the custom



duties, shipping, handling and other service charges that the carriers charge to get the product to your door step. Thus, what you see is what you finally pay. Its search engine is pretty straightforward as well; with results showing the final prices. Another advantage of purchasing on eBay is the robust buyer protection mechanism that minimizes the chances of any kind of fraud or lapse in the com-

mitted transaction. You don't need to have a separate account for shopping at eBay Global Easy Buy; your eBay India account login can be used to make purchases.

Another advantage with Global Easy Buy is the ability to pay via interest-free EMIs, as long as you're paying via a credit card that is accepted. You can choose the three-month EMI option if a one time payment doesn't fit your budget. On the downside, your options are not as wide as they would be if you were buying from amazon.com or newegg.com; your options are limited to the Global Easy Buy listings. These listings differ from the ones found on the international ebay.com. While most of the global electronics sellers are listed; the availability of the products under Global Easy Buy are primarily dependent and decided upon by the international carriers who act as middlemen for shipping the products to your doorstep after clearing all dues.

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In operation for about two years now, SYW got into the action with the iPhone 4 launch. It was one of the few sites selling officially unlocked UK iPhone 4 handsets, for a staggering ₹45,000 each. SYW specialises in getting you products newly launched in the international market and are some time away from hitting the Indian shores. While checking the latest offerings on the site, we came across the latest Android tablet from Sony, the